by Everett have changed much anyhow. As Misner pointed out, “Bohr’s view of quantum mechanics was essentially totally accepted throughout the world by thousands of physicists doing it every day. And to expect that on the basis of a one hour talk by a kid he was going to totally change his viewpoint would be unrealistic.” Everett agreed, albeit more colorfully. There is only one existing recording of Everett’s voice, a tape of an informal interview by Misner in 1977. When Misner asks him about the Copenhagen visit, Everett and Misner’s laughter swallow the recording temporarily, and only a few words of Everett’s reply come through: “That was a hell of a—doomed from the beginning.”

Bohr’s inner circle simply dismissed Everett as a misguided young man. “With regard to Everett, neither I nor even Niels Bohr could have any patience with him, when he visited us in Copenhagen… in order to sell the hopelessly wrong ideas he had been encouraged, most unwisely, by Wheeler to develop,” wrote Rosenfeld years later. “He was undescribably stupid and could not understand the simplest things in quantum mechanics.” Indeed, Bohr himself had elevated his own principle of complementarity to such lofty heights it was a wonder he could see Everett at all from his perch. “On one of those unforgettable strolls during which Bohr would so openly disclose his innermost thoughts,” Rosenfeld wrote several years later, “Bohr declared, with intense conviction, that he saw the day when complementarity would be taught in the schools and become part of general education; and better than any religion, he added, a sense of complementarity would afford people the guidance they needed.” And Bohr was still unwilling to entertain the idea of a fully quantum world. “The brilliant demonstration given by Bohr of the limitation of classical concepts is not accompanied by even the slightest indication of new concepts by which to replace them,” complained Vladimir Fock, one of Bohr’s disciples. Ultimately, the differences in aims and assumptions between Everett and the Copenhagen camp virtually guaranteed mutual incomprehension and frustration.

After a long day of fruitless discussion with Bohr, Everett walked back to his Copenhagen hotel under the steel-gray afternoon twilight of the Danish sky, leaving quantum physics behind him. Drinking and smoking incessantly at the hotel bar—“He was sloppy and had a cigarette *all the time*,” recalled Suzanne Misner—Everett had another brilliant alcohol-